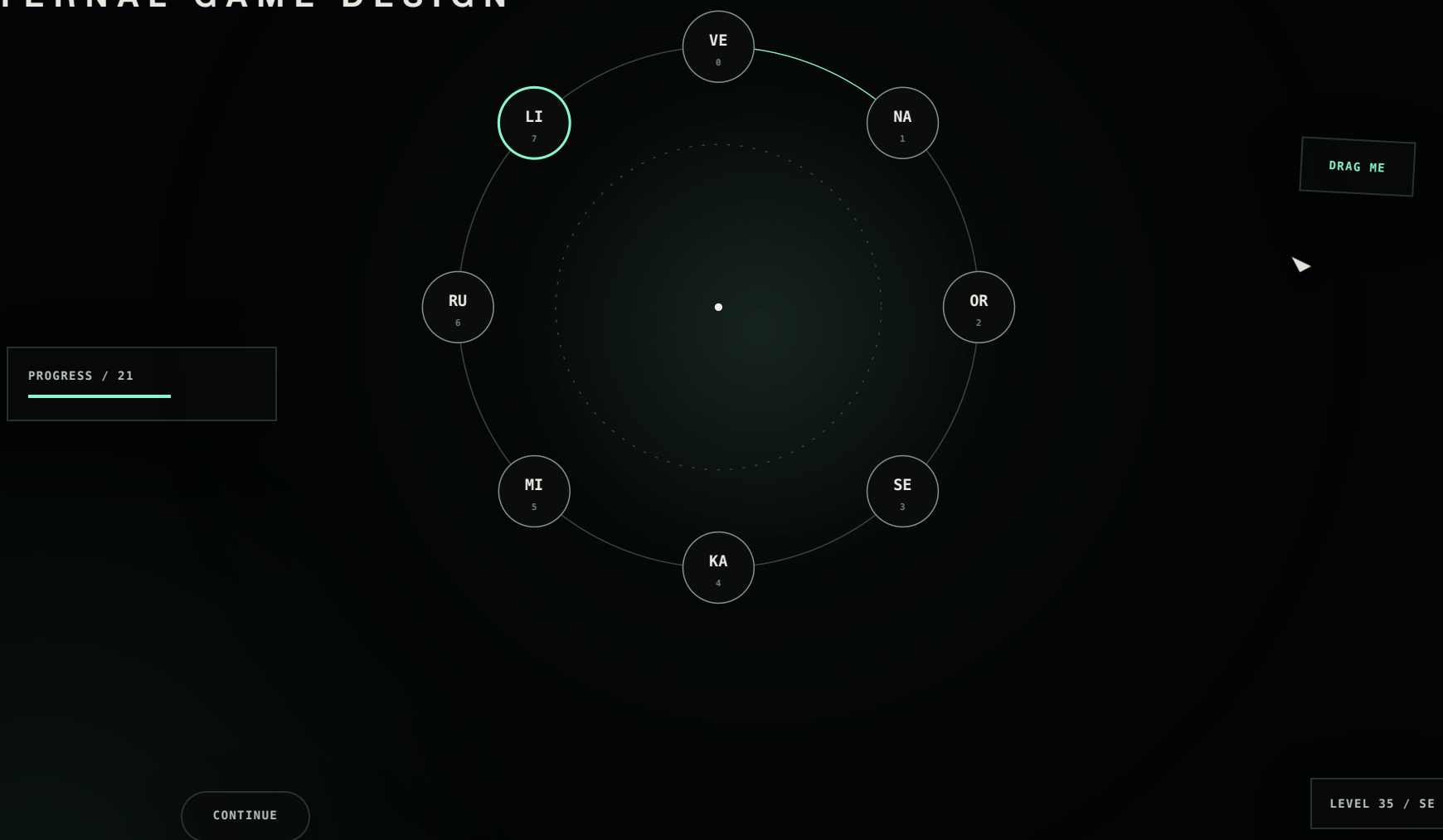


RULESET

CORE DESIGN • PUZZLE LANGUAGE • ECHO • COMPLETE SOLUTIONS

INTERNAL / FULL SPOILERS

INTERNAL GAME DESIGN



“Everything is part of the puzzle.”

RULESET

INTERNAL GAME DESIGN

A Game About Learning What You Were Never Told You Could Do

CORE DESIGN
PUZZLE LANGUAGE
ECHO
COMPLETE SOLUTIONS

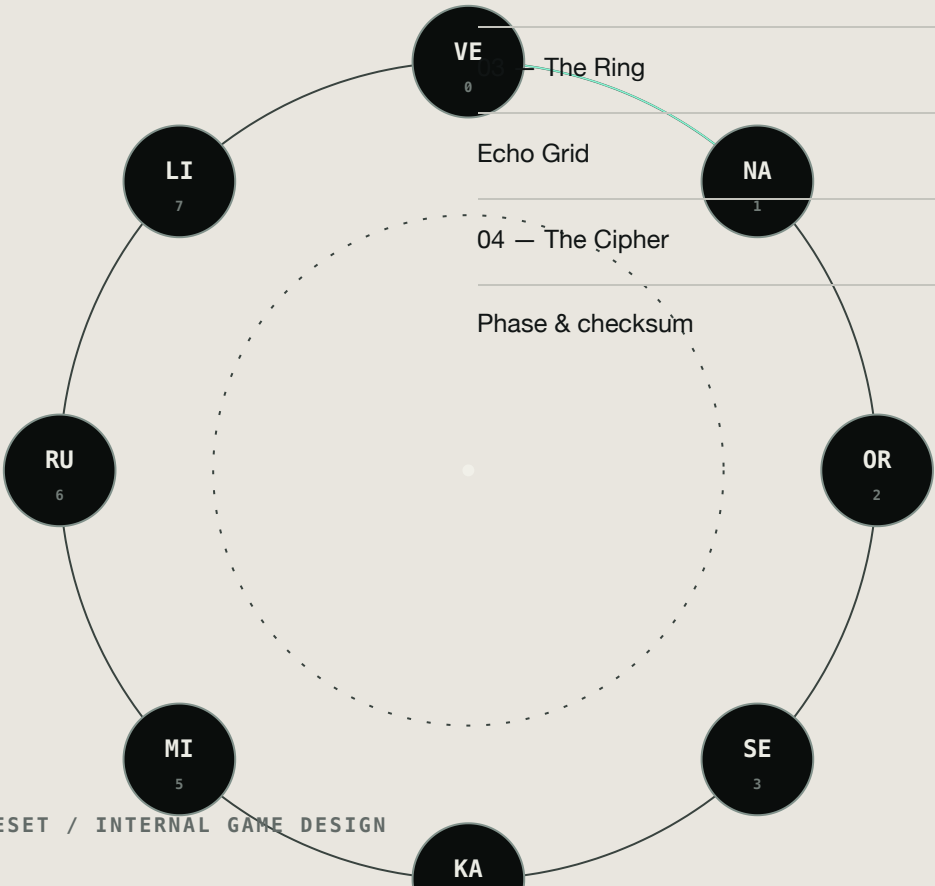
INTERNAL / FULL SPOILERS

This book treats the interface as a place, language as a tool, and player knowledge as the only inventory that truly matters.

DESIGN CANON / 01

A field manual
for a game
that rewrites
the meaning
of “interface.”

Central idea	04	30-day arc	30
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Everything on the screen may be part of the puzzle.

Text. Words. Numbers. Buttons. Instructions. Progress. Windows. Time. Input. Previous levels. Memory. The interface itself.

RULESET is a minimalist puzzle game about assumptions. It is not primarily math, trivia, detective fiction, platforming, combat, 2D, or 3D. It teaches a rule, lets that rule settle into instinct, then asks the player to recognize it somewhere they did not expect.

DEFINING REACTION

“WAIT...
I CAN DO THAT?”

FOLLOWED IMMEDIATELY BY

“Of course.
That makes perfect sense.”

The Puzzle Contract

MANIFESTO / I

Surprise the player. Never betray them.

01 Every puzzle has a logical solution.

03 Surprise is encouraged. Randomness is not.

05 Never repeat the same trick without transforming it.

07 Difficulty comes from reasoning, not pixel hunting.

02 The player receives enough information to infer that solution.

04 Never require obscure computer knowledge unless the game teaches it first.

06 Mechanics may return only if they are combined or recontextualized.

08 No invisible one-pixel click targets.

The Puzzle Contract

MANIFESTO / II

Every interaction is a lesson. Every lesson remains true.

09 No pure guessing.

11 Wording may mislead. The underlying rules may not contradict themselves.

13 The interface exists inside the game world.

15 The strongest puzzles permanently change how the player sees later levels.

10 Hints preserve the “aha”.

12 Every interaction should teach something.

14 The best solutions can be explained in one sentence afterward.

LEARN WORDS.
FORM SENTENCES.
THINK IN RULESET.

01

SEASON I / LEVELS 1-15

BREAK THE RULE

The interface conventions are not sacred.

Difficulty comes from interpretation, not dexterity.

Season I expands the player's idea of what counts as an object. A word becomes draggable. A number can be resized. A timer can be removed. A window can become a control. Knowledge can cross a level boundary.

Each puzzle grants permission. Later puzzles spend it.

- WHAT SHOULD I CLICK?
- WHAT CAN MOVE?
- WHAT IS THE INSTRUCTION MADE OF?
- WHAT AM I ALLOWED TO MANIPULATE?

Season I Mechanic Gallery

CONCEPTUAL PUZZLE MOCKUPS / 1-5

01

DRAG THE WORD

01

DRAG THE SQUARE



Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

THE INSTRUCTION IS AN OBJECT.

02

MAKE 5 BIGGER

02

5 > 10

Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

SIZE CAN REDEFINE COMPARISON.

03

REMOVE RED

03

PRESS ~~RED~~ BLUE

Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

WORDING CAN BE EDITED.

04

DEFEAT RESET

04

RESET / 00:03



Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

A TIMER IS A GAME OBJECT.

05

DO NOTHING

05

DO NOT TOUCH



Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

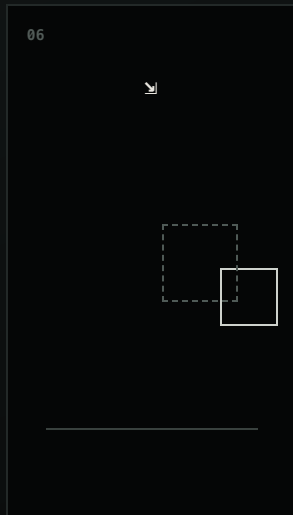
INACTION IS A VALID INPUT.

Season I Mechanic Gallery

CONCEPTUAL PUZZLE MOCKUPS / 6-10

06

RESIZE VIEW

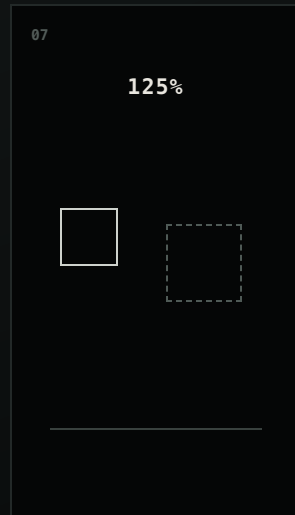


Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

THE WINDOW IS A CONTROL.

07

ZOOM TO READ

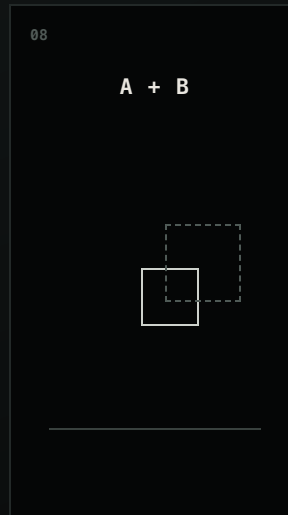


Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

SCALE CAN REVEAL
INFORMATION.

08

PRESS TOGETHER

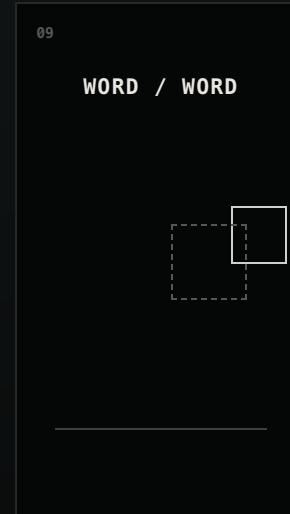


Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

SIMULTANEITY IS A VERB.

09

REORDER SENTENCE

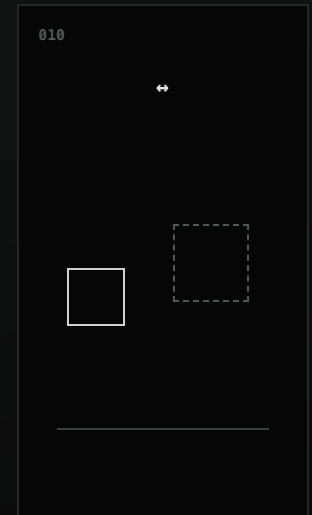


Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

GRAMMAR IS PHYSICAL.

10

REMAP CONTROL



Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

INPUT CONVENTIONS CAN
MOVE.

11

OUTSIDE FRAME

011

← ?

Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

THE EXPECTED AREA IS NOT THE WORLD.

12

HIDDEN WORD

012

[]

Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

ABSENCE CAN CARRY TEXT.

13

DECORATIVE UI

013

●

Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

DECORATION MAY RESPOND.

14

CARRY KNOWLEDGE

014

L-09

Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

MEMORY IS INVENTORY.

15

YOU CANNOT FINISH

015

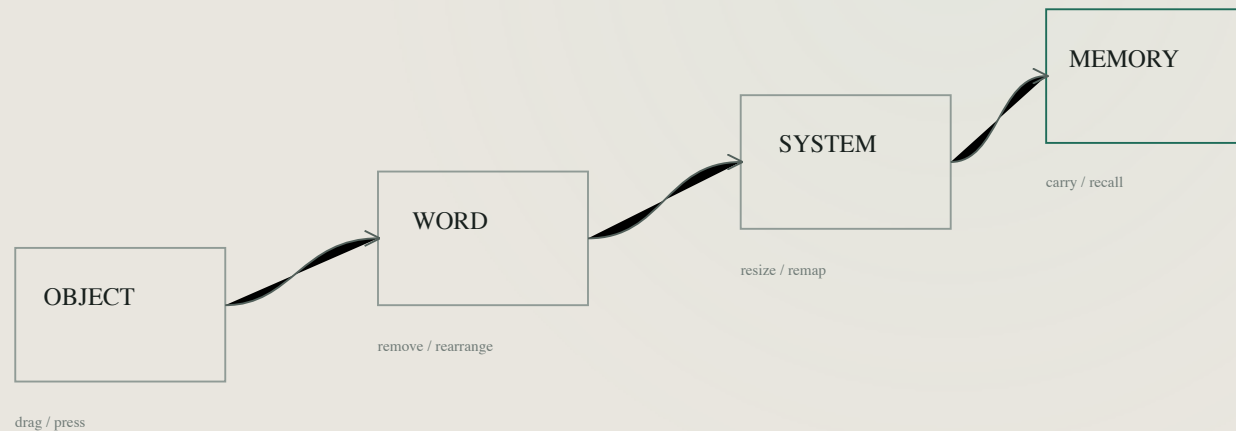
CANNOT

Not a screenshot. A directional fragment showing how the puzzle surface expands.

THE CLAIM ITSELF CAN BE CHANGED.

The puzzle surface keeps widening.

No trick is repeated unchanged. A mechanic may return only after it has become a word inside a larger sentence.



PLAYER MODEL EXPANSION

YOU ARE READY TO READ.

BLACK SCREEN / SILENCE / NO VICTORY FANFARE

02

VE

LI

NA

RULESET // II / CODENAME ECHO

LEARN TO READ

RU

OR

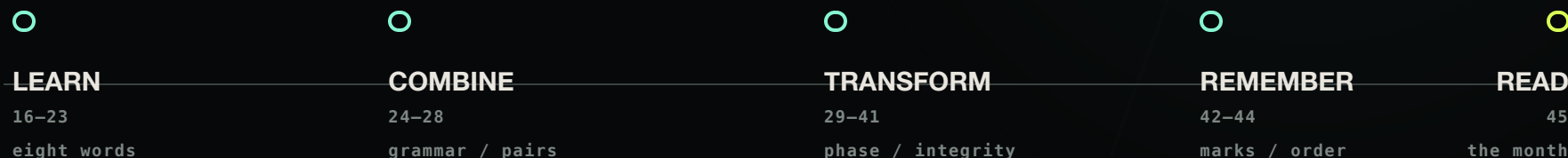
30 Levels / approximately 30 Days

MI

SE

KA

First, a tiny fictional language. Then, a symbolic information system. Finally, proof that the entire month has been writing one message.



WORDS → POSITIONS → CHARACTERS → MEMORY

Echo Tokens

TYPOGRAPHIC ARTIFACTS / 00-03

VE 00	NA 01	OR 02	SE 03
MOVE	THIS / CURRENT TARGET	LEFT	RIGHT
FIRST CONCEPTUAL USE MOVEMENT REACTS TO VE	FIRST CONCEPTUAL USE NA IDENTIFIES THE LIVE TARGET	FIRST CONCEPTUAL USE FIRST DIRECTIONAL CONTRAST	FIRST CONCEPTUAL USE MIRRORS OR AS OPPOSITE

TOKEN / MEANING / INDEX / FIRST USE

They are words made from ordinary type. Their strangeness comes from context, not fantasy ornament.

Echo Tokens

TYPOGRAPHIC ARTIFACTS / 04–07

KA

04

NOT / NEGATE

FIRST CONCEPTUAL USE
NEGATES THE FOLLOWING ACTION

MI

05

ONE

FIRST CONCEPTUAL USE
CONSTRAINS ACTION COUNT

RU

06

REPEAT

FIRST CONCEPTUAL USE
REPLAYS DEMONSTRATED MOVEMENT

LI

07

LIGHT / REVEAL

FIRST CONCEPTUAL USE
LIGHT UNCOVERS HIDDEN
INFORMATION

TOKEN / MEANING / INDEX / FIRST USE

They are words made from ordinary type. Their strangeness comes from context, not fantasy ornament.

Echo Grammar

CANONICAL SENTENCE FORM



[KA]? [RU]? ACTION TARGET [DIRECTION]? [COUNT]?

VE NA

Move this.

VE NA OR

Move this left.

VE NA SE

Move this right.

KA VE NA

Do not move this.

VE NA MI

Move this once.

RU VE NA

Repeat the demonstrated move.

LI NA

Reveal this.

LANGUAGE IS THE FIRST INTERFACE.

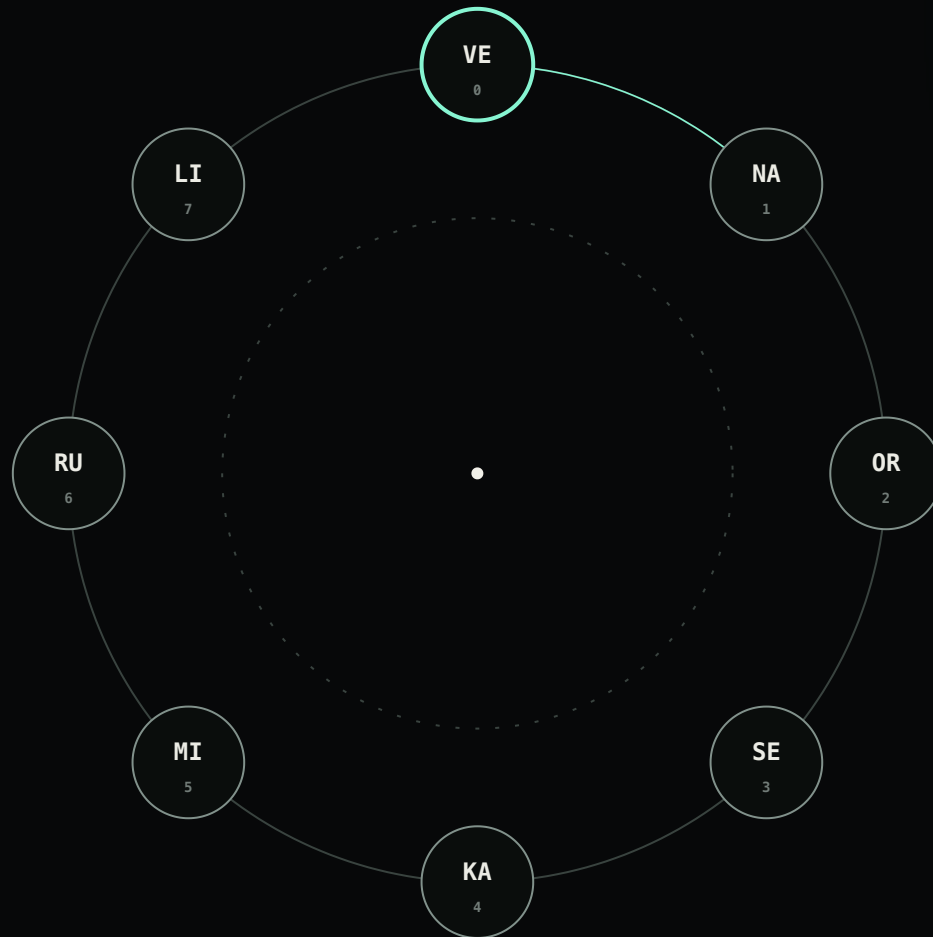
03



The words are also numbers.

The Echo Ring

CANONICAL ORDER / CLOCKWISE



Language becomes number.

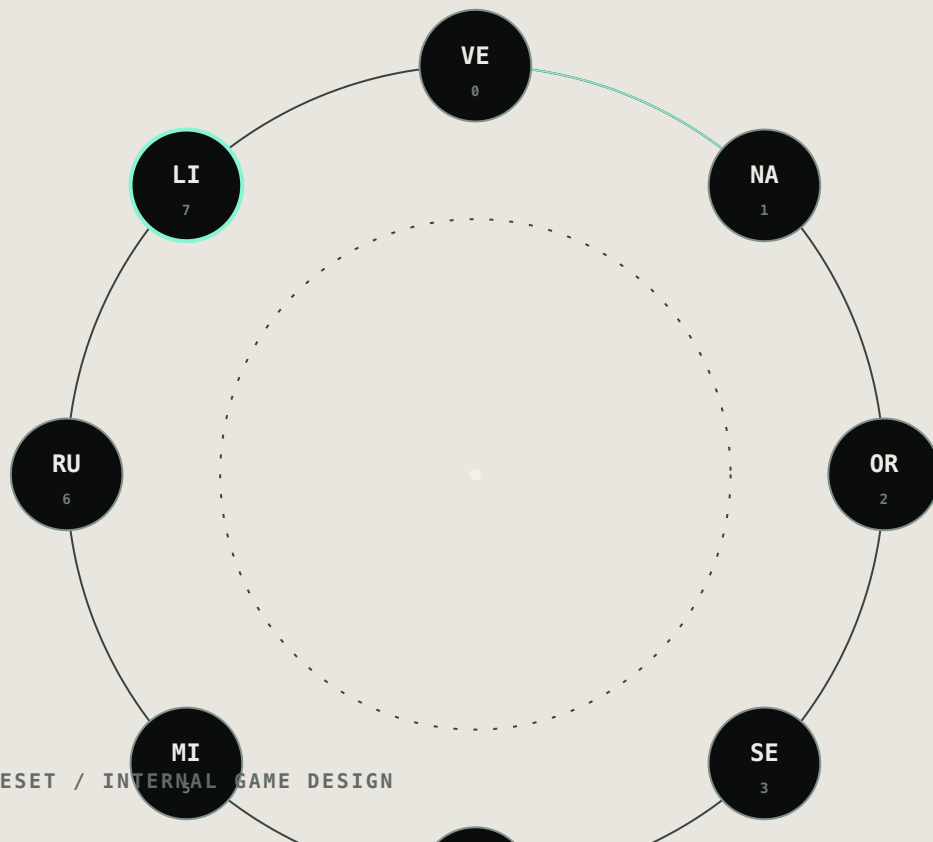
The player first reads **VE NA OR SE KA MI RU LI** as a vocabulary.

Level 26 turns the introduction order into a circular coordinate system. The meanings remain true; each token gains an index.

0 VE / 1 NA / 2 OR / 3 SE
4 KA / 5 MI / 6 RU / 7 LI

Rotation / Wraparound

THE SAME ORDER / A NEW ORIGIN



A ring has no edge.

Move one position forward from LI / 7 and the system returns to VE / 0. Rotation changes what is visible at a position, not the underlying eight-token order.

NORMAL ORDER → ROTATED ORDER → NORMALIZED ORDER

.

THE VISIBLE TOKENS ARE NOT THE MEANING.

The Echo Grid

8 × 8 / ROW TOKEN + COLUMN TOKEN

	VE 0	NA 1	OR 2	SE 3	KA 4	MI 5	RU 6	LI 7
VE 0	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
NA 1	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P
OR 2	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X
SE 3	Y	Z	0	1	2	3	4	5
KA 4	6	7	8	9	[SPACE]	.	,	!
MI 5	?	—	:	;	+	/	(	)
RU 6	[	]	{	}	<	>	@	#
LI 7	%	&	*	_	=	'	"	\$

WORKED COORDINATE

VE + RU

row 0

column 6

= G

Every pair of Echo tokens identifies exactly one character.

Reading Coordinates

WORKED EXAMPLES

Read the first token as a row. Read the second as a column. The intersection is the character.

ROW 0 COLUMN 6 INDEX 6 G	ROW 1 COLUMN 6 INDEX 14 O	ROW 5 COLUMN 0 INDEX 40 ?	ROW 6 COLUMN 6 INDEX 54 @
--	---	---	---

PAIR ORDER MATTERS: $VE + RU = G$ / $RU + VE = [$

04

SE KA MI MI LI KA

GAME CIPHER / TRANSFORMATION

THE CIPHER

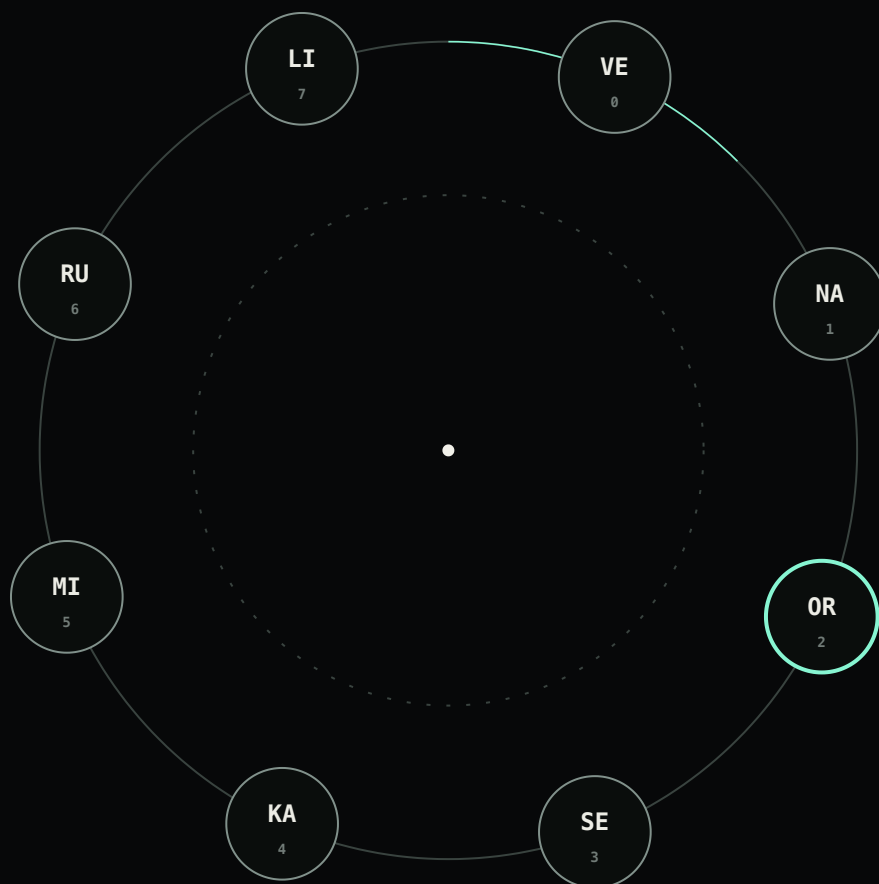
Shift what is visible. Preserve what it means.

PHASE + PAYLOAD + CHECKSUM

VE SE NA NA RU SE

Phase Encoding

ECHO IS A GAME CIPHER



A phase rotates every token around the same ring.

To encode, move forward by the phase. To decode, move backward. The player experiences this as turning a dial until the language returns to its familiar shape.

**encodedIndex =
(index +
phase) mod 8**

Move forward around the ring.

**normalizedIndex
=
(encodedIndex -
phase + 8) mod
8**

DESIGNED FOR PUZZLE PLAY. NOT SECURE REAL-WORLD
ENCIPHERMENT.

Move backward to restore
meaning.

Explicit Phase / Full Decode

ILLUSTRATED WORKED EXAMPLE

The first token declares how far the remaining message has been rotated.

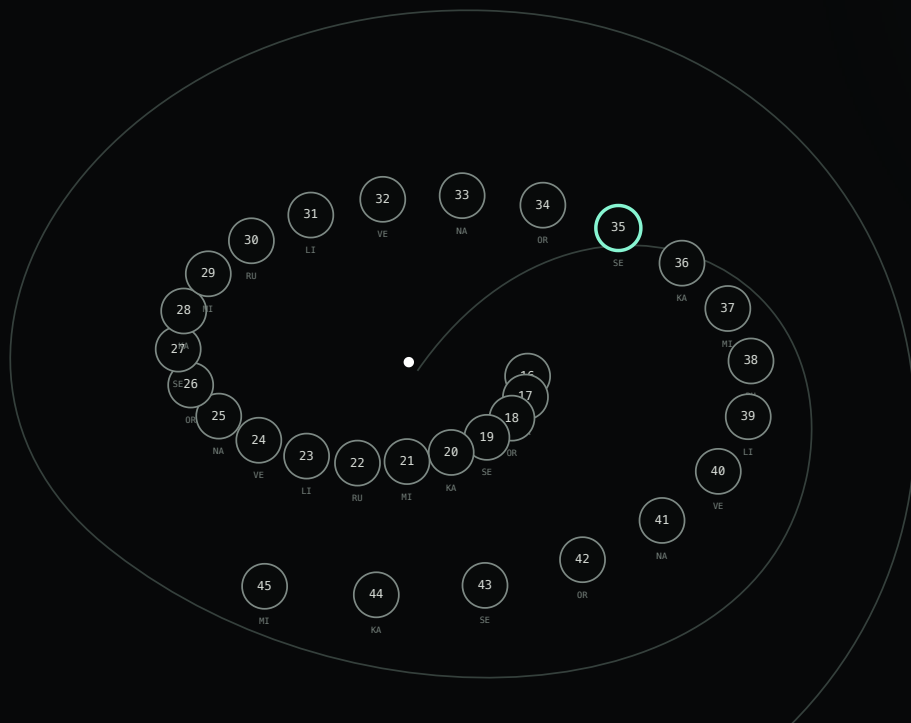


EXAMPLE PLAINTEXT: OPEN / EXPLICIT PHASE: OR / 2

Decode it. Then OPEN the object.

Implicit Level Phase

$$\text{LEVELPHASE} = (\text{LEVELID} - 16) \bmod 8$$



The Level number becomes part of the message.

After Level 34, the explicit prefix disappears. Place the current Level on the Ring, then normalize the payload.

16 VE / 17 NA / 18 OR / 19 SE
20 KA / 21 MI / 22 RU / 23 LI
24 VE / THE CYCLE REPEATS

Checksum

ECHO IS A GAME CIPHER

Hiding meaning is different
from proving whether
something changed.

```
checksum = sum(all normalized payload token  
indices) mod 8
```

The result is represented by one Echo token.

PHASE / PAYLOAD / CHECKSUM

OR · RU NA · KA SE · MI

normalized sum → 5 mod 8 → MI

VALID

ONE TOKEN ALTERED

OR · RU NA · **MI** SE · MI

normalized sum → 6 mod 8 → RU
declared checksum → MI

ALTERED

The 30-Day Echo Arc

LEVELS 16–45

ACT I

LEARN TO READ

LEVELS 16–23
8 LEVELS



ACT II

DISCOVER THE
SYSTEM

LEVELS 24–33
10 LEVELS



ACT III

BREAK THE
BOUNDARIES

LEVELS 34–41
8 LEVELS



ACT IV

LOOK BACK

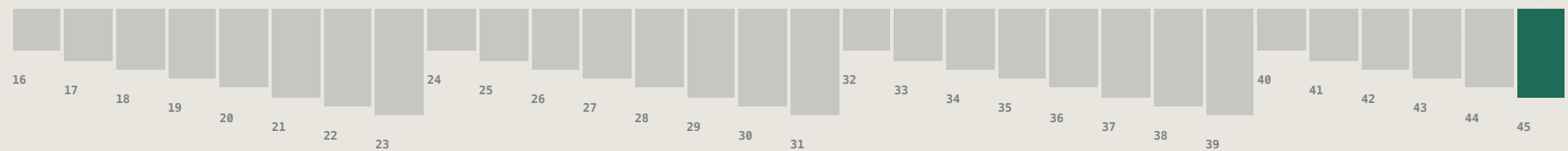
LEVELS 42–44
3 LEVELS



FINALE

THE MONTH

LEVELS 45
1 LEVEL



ONE MARK PER LEVEL / ONE MONTH / ONE SENTENCE

16

DAY 01

VE / MOVE

PHASE 0 / VE



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

One object, one destination, and only VE.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

The lone word may be a label.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

VE means movement.

SOLUTION

Drag the object to the destination; VE reacts to movement.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Motion is the only changing event and the word visibly answers it.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Actions can be learned without translation.

HINT 1

Try the obvious physical action.

HINT 2

Watch the word as the object moves.

HINT 3

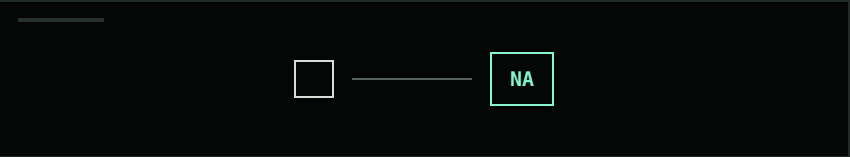
Drag the object into the destination.

17

DAY 02

NA / THIS

PHASE 1 / NA



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

VE NA above three movable objects; one is subtly identified.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Any object can satisfy MOVE.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

NA means this / current target.

SOLUTION

Move only the object marked by NA.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The target has a restrained but consistent NA response.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Grammar can bind action to target.

HINT 1

Not all three objects are equivalent.

HINT 2

Look for what NA is identifying.

HINT 3

Move only the subtly marked object.

18

DAY 03

OR / LEFT

PHASE 2 / OR



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES	
VE NA OR; target centered between two destinations.	
PLAYER ASSUMPTION	SOLUTION
Either destination is valid.	Move NA into the left destination.
NEW KNOWLEDGE	WHY IT IS FAIR
OR means left.	The prior two tokens are known; only direction is new.
WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES	
Directional modifiers follow targets.	

- HINT 1

Two tokens are already readable.
- HINT 2

The final token chooses a side.
- HINT 3

Move the target left.

19

DAY 04

SE / RIGHT

PHASE 3 / SE



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES	
VE NA SE; a conceptual mirror of Level 18.	
PLAYER ASSUMPTION	SOLUTION
SE may be another object property.	Move NA into the right destination.
NEW KNOWLEDGE	WHY IT IS FAIR
SE means right, the opposite of OR.	Mirrored staging isolates one changed token.
WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES	
Paired opposites can be inferred relationally.	

- HINT 1

Compare this composition to Level 18.
- HINT 2

Only the direction token changed.
- HINT 3

Move the target right.

20

DAY 05

KA / NOT

PHASE 4 / KA



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

KA VE NA; every visual affordance invites dragging.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Movement is always required.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

KA negates the action that follows.

SOLUTION

Leave the target untouched until success.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The familiar sentence remains intact except for one prefix.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Inaction can be a precise command.

HINT 1

The first token changes the known sentence.

HINT 2

Read KA as acting on VE.

HINT 3

Do not move the target.

21

DAY 06

MI / ONE

PHASE 5 / MI



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

VE NA MI; a target can be moved repeatedly.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Reach a destination by any number of steps.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

MI means one.

SOLUTION

Perform exactly one valid movement.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The interface counts discrete valid moves and communicates overrun.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Tokens can quantify actions.

HINT 1

The final token constrains quantity.

HINT 2

Count valid movements, not cursor motion.

HINT 3

Make exactly one valid move.

22

DAY 07

RU / REPEAT

PHASE 6 / RU



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

A movement is silently demonstrated, followed by RU VE NA.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

The animation is decoration or instruction flavor.

SOLUTION

Reproduce the demonstrated movement.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

RU means repeat.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The demonstration is clear, brief, and repeatable.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

A token can refer to prior state.

HINT 1

The opening motion mattered.

HINT 2

RU points backward to the demonstration.

HINT 3

Repeat the exact shown movement.

23

DAY 08

LI / REVEAL

PHASE 7 / LI



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

LI NA in darkness; a movable light source is present.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Move the target despite poor visibility.

SOLUTION

Move the light across NA until hidden information appears.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

LI means light / reveal.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The light visibly changes the readable surface.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Theme and illumination can expose data.

HINT 1

The darkness is functional.

HINT 2

LI changes visibility, not position.

HINT 3

Sweep the light over NA.

24

DAY 09

FIRST SENTENCE

PHASE 0 / VE



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

VE NA OR MI with a target and stepped destinations.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Four learned words may still be separate prompts.

SOLUTION

Move this left one.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

A full Echo sentence can be read as a unit.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Every word was isolated and tested in the previous eight levels.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Fluent grammar precedes manipulation.

HINT 1

Read left to right.

HINT 2

Action, target, direction, count.

HINT 3

Move the target left exactly once.

25

DAY 10

GRAMMAR

PHASE 1 / NA



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

MI / NA / SE / VE appear as physical scrambled tokens.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Execute them in visible order.

SOLUTION

Rearrange to VE NA SE MI, then move this right once.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

Language itself is manipulable.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Canonical sentence order was demonstrated in Level 24.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Tokens can be objects and data simultaneously.

HINT 1

The words are correct; their order is not.

HINT 2

Rebuild action-target-direction-count.

HINT 3

Arrange VE NA SE MI and execute.

26

DAY 11

ECHO RING

PHASE 2 / OR



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

The eight token introductions are available as movable history fragments.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

The task is a chronology recap.

SOLUTION

Order VE NA OR SE KA MI RU LI; the line closes into a ring and reveals 0–7.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

Tokens possess stable numeric identities.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The order is exactly the order the player learned them.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Indexing, phase, and the final key.

HINT 1

Recall introduction order.

HINT 2

Build a sequence from Levels 16–23.

HINT 3

VE NA OR SE KA MI RU LI.

27

DAY 12

TOKEN PAIRS

PHASE 3 / SE



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

An empty 8×8 board labeled with Echo tokens on both axes.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Tokens still form only sentences.

SOLUTION

Use a given pair such as OR LI as row then column.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

Two tokens can be coordinates.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The Ring just established stable ordered positions.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Pairs will become characters.

HINT 1

Treat the labels as axes.

HINT 2

First token is row; second is column.

HINT 3

Find the OR row / LI column intersection.

28

DAY 13

ECHO GRID

PHASE 4 / KA



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

The coordinate board fills with the canonical 64-character sequence.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

The letters are decoration or a lookup reward.

SOLUTION

Decode two supplied pairs as G and O.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

Token pair = character.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The board exposes every coordinate and character explicitly.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Messages can exist without semantic Echo grammar.

HINT 1

Use the board exactly as last Level.

HINT 2

Each pair identifies one cell.

HINT 3

Decode both pairs to read GO.

29

DAY 14

PHASE

PHASE 5 / MI



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

The Ring visibly rotates; a phase token precedes a small payload.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Tokens have changed meanings.

SOLUTION

Rotate payload tokens backward by the declared phase.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

Visible identity can be shifted while normalized identity stays stable.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The rotation animation shows the mapping rather than hiding it.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Actual encoded messages.

HINT 1

The order did not change. The origin did.

HINT 2

Use the first token as rotation distance.

HINT 3

Shift every payload token backward.

30

DAY 15

FIRST REAL DECODE

PHASE 6 / RU



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

A phase prefix, encoded payload, Echo Grid, and a closed central object.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Decoding the word is the finish.

SOLUTION

Decode OPEN, then physically open the central object.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

Plaintext can instruct action.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Every decode operation was taught separately.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Cipher and interface will combine.

HINT 1

Follow phase → normalize → pair → grid.

HINT 2

The plaintext is an instruction.

HINT 3

Decode OPEN and open the object.

31

DAY 16

SAME PLAINTEXT

PHASE 7 / LI



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

Two visibly different phase-encoded messages and a SAME / DIFFERENT choice.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Different tokens must mean different messages.

SOLUTION

Normalize both; each reads OPEN; choose SAME.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

Ciphertext is not meaning.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Both phase declarations are visible and use the learned rule.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Look for invariants, not appearances.

HINT 1

Compare after normalization.

HINT 2

Different rotations can restore one sequence.

HINT 3

Both decode to OPEN; choose SAME.

32

DAY 17

ENCODE

PHASE 0 / VE



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

Plaintext KEY, a declared phase, and draggable Echo tokens.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

All cipher tasks are decoding tasks.

SOLUTION

Convert KEY to Grid pairs, then shift every token forward by phase.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

The transformation works in both directions.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Encoding is the exact inverse of the practiced decode.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Player-authored ciphertext and checksum reasoning.

HINT 1

Start with Grid coordinates.

HINT 2

Then rotate forward, not backward.

HINT 3

Build KEY pairs and add the phase.

33

DAY 18

ECHO

PHASE 1 / NA



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

Every restart displays a new phase and different visible payload.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Restart randomizes the answer.

SOLUTION

Normalize any version; all read ECHO.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

What stays constant is the plaintext.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Every variation follows the same declared system.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Level memory later references this answer.

HINT 1

Track what changes and what cannot.

HINT 2

Normalize each restart before comparing.

HINT 3

Every version decodes to ECHO.

34

DAY 19

DECODE + BREAK UI

PHASE 2 / OR



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

An encoded message and the persistent global Hint control.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

The Hint button is outside the puzzle.

SOLUTION

Decode DRAG HINT, then drag the global Hint control into the playfield.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

Season I interface permission and Echo literacy combine.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Both constituent mechanics were taught directly.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

System UI will become cipher hardware.

HINT 1

The plaintext names something on screen.

HINT 2

Remember Season I: interface can move.

HINT 3

Decode DRAG HINT and drag the Hint control.

35

DAY 20

LEVEL = PHASE

PHASE 3 / SE



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

No phase prefix; Level 35 is unusually emphasized.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

The message is incomplete.

SOLUTION

$(35 - 16) \bmod 8 = 3$ / SE; normalize and decode OPEN.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

The Level number is part of the message.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The missing prefix and emphasized Level number make one clean substitution.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Every stored mark can use its source Level.

HINT 1

What visible number could replace the prefix?

HINT 2

Place 35 in the eight-step cycle.

HINT 3

Use phase 3 / SE, then decode OPEN.

36

DAY 21

PERSISTENCE

PHASE 4 / KA



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

A hidden SE token, revealed through theme/light interaction; message KEEP SE.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

The token is a local answer.

SOLUTION

Reveal SE and place it into the persistent Echo Tray.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

A token can survive between levels.

WHY IT IS FAIR

KEEP names the exact new action and the tray opens visibly.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Cross-level objects and remembered marks.

HINT 1

First reveal the token.

HINT 2

KEEP means the level should not consume it.

HINT 3

Put SE in Echo Tray.

37

DAY 22

CROSS-LEVEL OBJECT

PHASE 5 / MI



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

An incomplete coordinate pair and the still-visible Echo Tray.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

The missing token must be found locally.

SOLUTION

Retrieve SE from the tray, complete the pair, and let it be consumed.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

Persistent state can become puzzle input.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The saved token remains visible and uniquely fits the absence.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Memory is an actionable interface.

HINT 1

Something already belongs in the gap.

HINT 2

Check what survived Level 36.

HINT 3

Drag SE from Echo Tray into the pair.

38

DAY 23

MEMORY AS INPUT

PHASE 6 / RU



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

Encrypted instruction USE 33 and a text input field.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

33 is a quantity or phase.

SOLUTION

Recall Level 33 resolved to ECHO; enter ECHO.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

Previous knowledge is a tool.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The instruction names the exact source Level and that Level had one invariant answer.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Finale asks the player to reread the month.

HINT 1

33 is a Level reference.

HINT 2

What remained constant there?

HINT 3

Enter ECHO.

39

DAY 24

PROGRESS DIAL

PHASE 7 / LI



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

Ciphertext plus the global progress indicator, now draggable across eight detents.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Progress only reports completion.

SOLUTION

Set the bar to LI / 7 until ciphertext normalizes to OPEN.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

A global status display can operate the cipher.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Eight snap positions mirror the Ring and give immediate feedback.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

System surfaces can embody abstract rules.

HINT 1

The control has exactly eight positions.

HINT 2

Treat it as the Ring origin.

HINT 3

Set progress to LI / 7.

40

DAY 25

MESSAGE INTEGRITY

PHASE 0 / VE



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES	
Two readable messages; one differs by a single normalized token. Checksums are shown.	
PLAYER ASSUMPTION	SOLUTION
Readable means authentic.	Sum normalized payload indices mod 8 and select the matching checksum.
NEW KNOWLEDGE	WHY IT IS FAIR
Meaning and integrity are separate properties.	The checksum rule is demonstrated with visible running totals.
WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES	
Expectation must not override verification.	

HINT 1	HINT 2	HINT 3
Both can be read; only one can be verified.	Add normalized token indices mod 8.	Choose the message whose sum matches its checksum token.

41

DAY 26

CHECKSUM + WAIT

PHASE 1 / NA



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES	
Three encoded instructions; only one checksum is valid.	
PLAYER ASSUMPTION	SOLUTION
Pick the most actionable or familiar command.	Verify the authentic plaintext WAIT; then make no input for several seconds.
NEW KNOWLEDGE	WHY IT IS FAIR
Integrity outranks expectation; inaction returns as a learned verb.	Checksum selects one message, and Level 20 established waiting as valid input.
WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES	
Finale synthesis across distant lessons.	

HINT 1	HINT 2	HINT 3
Do not trust plausibility.	Validate checksums before acting.	Choose WAIT, then touch nothing.

42

DAY 27

LOOK BACK

PHASE 2 / OR



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

A difficult valid message decodes to LOOK BACK; history control activates.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

The phrase is reflective flavor text.

SOLUTION

Open history; ECHO MEMORY reveals every prior decorative mark.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

The decorative marks were stored data.

WHY IT IS FAIR

The explicit instruction names the available history action.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Access to the finale payload.

HINT 1

Treat the plaintext literally.

HINT 2

There is now a way to revisit history.

HINT 3

Activate history to open ECHO MEMORY.

43

DAY 28

READING MEMORY

PHASE 3 / SE



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

Four synthetic two-token marks with source Level IDs.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

All marks share one phase.

SOLUTION

Use each source Level as its own phase; normalize and decode ECHO.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

Every mark inherits the implicit phase of its source Level.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Level 35 taught Level-as-phase; synthetic data prevents damaging real marks.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Mass normalization in Level 45.

HINT 1

The Level label belongs to each mark.

HINT 2

Compute phase separately per source.

HINT 3

Normalize all four and read ECHO.

44

DAY 29

ORDER

PHASE 4 / KA



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

Five synthetic marks displayed out of sequence.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

Screen order is message order.

SOLUTION

Sort by Level ID, normalize per Level, decode READY.

NEW KNOWLEDGE

ORDER = LEVEL.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Every mark carries an explicit source and chronological order is unambiguous.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

Final message assembly.

HINT 1

The display order is suspicious.

HINT 2

Use source chronology.

HINT 3

Sort by Level, then decode READY.

45

DAY 30

THE MONTH

PHASE 5 / MI



WHAT THE PLAYER SEES

No instruction. Echo Memory opens with all 29 real marks; later, an eight-slot lock.

PLAYER ASSUMPTION

A final rule or hidden clue is missing.

SOLUTION

Order by Level, derive each phase, normalize, Grid-decode YOU BUILT THE KEY. USE IT NOW; enter VE NA OR SE KA MI RU LI. The game answers: YOU CAN READ RULESET NOW. Pause. BUT CAN RULESET READ YOU?

NEW KNOWLEDGE

The month built the message; the player built the key.

WHY IT IS FAIR

Every operation and the key order were previously learned.

WHAT IT SECRETLY PREPARES

The closing question, not a new puzzle.

HINT 1

Use everything Memory just taught.

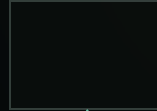
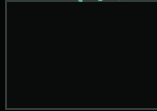
HINT 2

The key was personally reconstructed in Level 26.

HINT 3

Decode all marks; enter VE NA OR SE KA MI RU LI.

05



PERSISTENCE / HISTORY / RECALL



MEMORY



The decoration was data.



A token survives the cut.

Level 36 asks the player to keep SE. Level 37 makes a coordinate pair incomplete. The token is retrieved from the persistent tray, completes the pair, and is consumed.

LESSON: OBJECTS CAN CROSS LEVEL BOUNDARIES.

ECHO MEMORY

29 MARKS / SOURCE ORDER HIDDEN

SE VE 16	OR LI 17	KA RU 18	LI LI 19	KA MI 20	LI NA 21	LI RU 22	VE OR 23	OR SE 24	MI MI 25
KA MI 26	SE OR 27	KA VE 28	NA NA 29	LI VE 30	LI SE 31	SE VE 32	MI RU 33	RU RU 34	MI LI 35
RU RU 36	MI NA 37	OR OR 38	VE LI 39	OR SE 40	MI MI 41	SE LI 42	KA NA 43	RU OR 44	



Reading Memory

TRAINING BEFORE THE FINALE

LEVEL 43 / NORMALIZE

Four synthetic marks spell ECHO.



LEVEL 44 / ORDER

Five marks spell READY only after sorting.

VISIBLE

44 / 42 / 40 / 43 / 41

ORDER = LEVEL

40 41 42 43 44 → READY

THE PLAYER NOW POSSESSES EVERY RULE REQUIRED.

06

LEVEL 45 / COMPLETE SYNTHESIS

THE MONTH WAS THE PUZZLE

No new rule. Every old rule, together.

Level 45 / The Complete Resolution

THE PLAYER'S KNOWLEDGE IS THE KEY

01

ORDER

Sort all 29 real marks by source Level.

02

PHASE

Calculate each implicit Level phase.

03

NORMALIZE

Rotate each two-token mark backward.

04

READ

Decode each pair through the Grid.

05

ACT

Use the key personally reconstructed in Level 26.

FINAL MEMORY MESSAGE

YOU BUILT THE KEY. USE IT NOW

VE

NA

OR

SE

KA

MI

RU

LI

THE KEY = VE NA OR SE KA MI RU LI

Secret Echo Mark Message

ENCODED PAIR = (NORMALIZED TOKEN INDEX + SOURCE LEVEL PHASE) MOD 8

LEVEL	PHASE	NORMALIZED PAIR	ENCODED PAIR	FINAL CHARACTER
16	0 / VE	SE + VE	SE + VE	Y
17	1 / NA	NA + RU	OR + LI	O
18	2 / OR	OR + KA	KA + RU	U
19	3 / SE	KA + KA	LI + LI	[SPACE]
20	4 / KA	VE + NA	KA + MI	B
21	5 / MI	OR + KA	LI + NA	U
22	6 / RU	NA + VE	LI + RU	I
23	7 / LI	NA + SE	VE + OR	L
24	0 / VE	OR + SE	OR + SE	T
25	1 / NA	KA + KA	MI + MI	[SPACE]
26	2 / OR	OR + SE	KA + MI	T
27	3 / SE	VE + LI	SE + OR	H
28	4 / KA	VE + KA	KA + VE	E
29	5 / MI	KA + KA	NA + NA	[SPACE]
30	6 / RU	NA + OR	LI + VE	K

PROGRAMMATICALLY DERIVED FROM THE CANONICAL 8 × 8 GRID

ORDER → PHASE → NORMALIZE → PAIR → READ

Secret Echo Mark Message

ENCODED PAIR = (NORMALIZED TOKEN INDEX + SOURCE LEVEL PHASE) MOD 8

LEVEL	PHASE	NORMALIZED PAIR	ENCODED PAIR	FINAL CHARACTER
31	7 / LI	VE + KA	LI + SE	E
32	0 / VE	SE + VE	SE + VE	Y
33	1 / NA	KA + MI	MI + RU	.
34	2 / OR	KA + KA	RU + RU	[SPACE]
35	3 / SE	OR + KA	MI + LI	U
36	4 / KA	OR + OR	RU + RU	S
37	5 / MI	VE + KA	MI + NA	E
38	6 / RU	KA + KA	OR + OR	[SPACE]
39	7 / LI	NA + VE	VE + LI	I
40	0 / VE	OR + SE	OR + SE	T
41	1 / NA	KA + KA	MI + MI	[SPACE]
42	2 / OR	NA + MI	SE + LI	N
43	3 / SE	NA + RU	KA + NA	O
44	4 / KA	OR + RU	RU + OR	W

PROGRAMMATICALLY DERIVED FROM THE CANONICAL 8 × 8 GRID

YOU BUILT THE KEY. USE IT NOW

Player Knowledge Graph

NOTHING LEARNED IS DISCARDED



Why the Finale Is Fair

THE PUREST FORM OF RULESET

The finale introduces no new arbitrary rule.

TOKEN SEMANTICS

The eight meanings were learned through direct action.

TOKEN ORDER

Introduction chronology was reconstructed in Level 26.

NUMERIC IDENTITY

The Ring permanently attached 0–7 to the tokens.

PAIR COORDINATES

Rows and columns were practiced before characters appeared.

ECHO GRID

Every pair-to-character mapping remains visible and exact.

PHASE SHIFTING

Encode and decode were practiced in both directions.

LEVEL PHASE

Level 35 made source Level part of the cipher.

PERSISTENT MEMORY

Tray, history, and Echo Memory established durable state.

CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER

Level 44 explicitly taught ORDER = LEVEL.

It asks only: **Can you combine what you already learned?**

LEVEL 45 / SYNTHESIS

KA VE NA



LEVEL 20 / NO INPUT DETECTED

HINT 1 / CONCEPT

Not every invitation is an instruction.

HINT 2 / MECHANIC

Consider what KA does to the action that follows it.

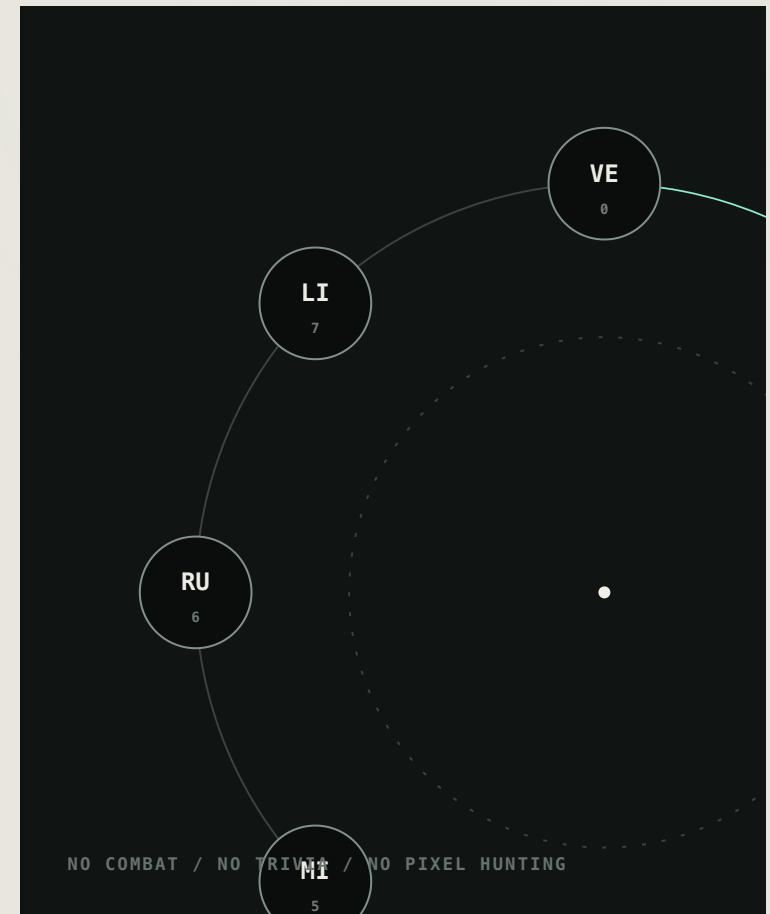
HINT 3 / NEAR-SOLUTION

KA VE NA means “Do not move this.” Leave the target untouched.

A minimalist puzzle game where the screen is not a frame around the puzzle.

It is the puzzle.

RULESET asks players to observe carefully, test assumptions, and learn a growing language of interaction. Every surprise follows a rule. Every solution feels impossible until it feels inevitable.



Why RULESET Can Grow

CREATOR NOTE

RULESET is not a collection of tricks. It is a way of teaching perception.

That makes expansion possible without erasing the player's intelligence.

Season I teaches that interface conventions are negotiable. Season II teaches that information can be transformed, indexed, remembered, and recombined. Future Seasons can introduce wholly new languages of interaction while respecting both lessons.

The constraint is continuity. New grammar should not invalidate old grammar; it should let old knowledge operate at a new scale. The player should feel more capable at the start

of each Season than they did at the start of the last.

A Season can change the medium of thought - space, sound, timing, collaboration, authorship - without changing the contract. Teach clearly. Transform deliberately. Recontextualize rather than repeat.

The long-term promise is not “more puzzles.” It is a growing literacy: the sensation that every solved rule permanently enlarges what the player can imagine doing next.

NEW LANGUAGE. SAME TRUST.

Glossary

CANONICAL TERMS

RULESET

The game and its governing promise: everything visible may participate.

Echo Token

One of eight typographic words with semantic and numeric identity.

Phase

A 0–7 rotation applied to token indices.

Plaintext

The characters obtained after normalization and Grid lookup.

Echo Memory

The interface that reveals all collected Season II marks.

Meta Puzzle

A puzzle assembled from knowledge and artifacts across multiple levels.

Mechanic

A taught action or relationship the player can reliably reuse.

Echo Ring

The clockwise order VE, NA, OR, SE, KA, MI, RU, LI.

Normalization

Rotating encoded tokens backward to restore canonical indices.

Checksum

A one-token integrity value: normalized payload index sum mod 8.

Implicit Phase

A phase derived from Level: $(\text{levelId} - 16) \bmod 8$.

Puzzle Surface

The complete manipulable field, including interface and history.

Echo Grid

The canonical 8×8 character table indexed by token pairs.

Ciphertext

The visible, phase-shifted token sequence.

Echo Mark

Exactly two encoded Echo tokens attached to one source Level.

Persistent State

An object or fact that survives beyond its source puzzle.

BUT CAN RULESET READ YOU?